



▲ **Sculpture of Lord William Bentinck**, who was the Governor-General of India from 1828 to 1835

THE EAST INDIA COMPANY

During the Mughal rule, a joint-stock company, called the East India Company (EIC), was formed in Britain in 1600 with a monopoly over trade in the East. Over the course of years, it expanded its trading activities and subsequently gained political control over India. In the second half of the 18th century, the British Parliament started closely monitoring and regulating the EIC's activities. It established the Government of India under the governor general in council, who reported to the Court of Directors of the EIC. The Court was placed under the Board of Control, whose chairman was a member of the Cabinet. The territorial units included "provinces", some of which were "presidencies", administered by governors. After the Revolt of 1857, the Crown took complete control of India.

Efforts towards road construction